

CULMINATING UNDERGRADUATE EXPERIENCE: THESIS WRITTEN THESIS MANUSCRIPT REQUIREMENTS

Effective Fall 2021 Term: APA Version 7.0

NOTE: For students who have already begun writing their thesis, Kettering will support version 6.0 until the end of Spring 2022 term. Thereafter, all students should be using version 7.0.

Kettering University has adopted the nationally recognized APA style/format for the written thesis manuscript. There are numerous resources available to reference APA style Version 7.0, which include:

- “Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association”, 7th Edition, Published by APA, ISBN: 978-1-4338-3217-8 (copies available in the Kettering Library)
- “Written Thesis Manuscript Modification Example”, an APA Version 7.0 initial setup to start developing the thesis manuscript. It is located in the Blackboard Faculty Thesis Advisor Organization as a PDF, currently a Word Doc is available upon request to thesis@kettering.edu.
- Purdue OWL for Format Specifications (https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/general_format.html)
- Academic Success Center Lab for Writing Support - (<https://my.kettering.edu/page/writing-support>)
- Kettering University Library - LibGuide for the Culminating Undergraduate Experience: Thesis (<https://libguides.kettering.edu/cile400>)
- ThinkingStorm Free Online Tutoring Available at (https://kettering.blackboard.com/webapps/portal/execute/tabs/tabAction?tabId= 41620_1&tab_group_id= 236_1)

Modifications to the APA Style that Kettering requires include:

- **Written in third person, active or passive voice (NOTE: N/A for Culminating Reflection Project)**
- **Left margin set at 1 ½ inch**
- **Predefined content in the “Author Note”**
- **Inclusion of the “Table of Contents” and “Conclusions and Recommendations” sections**
- **Order of the Kettering written thesis document**

The order required within the Kettering written thesis is to follow one of the two options in Table 1. The decision on what structure to use is to be agreed upon by the Student, Co-op Employer Thesis Advisor (Co-op Thesis Option only) and Kettering Faculty Thesis Advisor.

Table 1: Required Elements and Order of the Kettering Written Thesis Manuscript

Option 1 – Traditional Thesis	Option 2 – Custom Publication
1. Title Page: Title, Author Name & Author Note (*see provided guide))	1. Title Page: Title, Author Name & Author Note (*see provided guide)
2. Abstract	2. Abstract
3. Table of Contents (*see provided guide))	3. Table of Contents (*see provided guide)
4. Introduction	4. Introduction
5. Conclusions and Recommendations (*see provided guide)	5. Conclusions and Recommendations (*see provided guide)
6. Method	6. References (for section 1 -5 only)
7. Results	7. The text of a Journal Publication, Business Plan, Company Training Manual, etc. . . (1 ½” left margin and page numbering can be separate, meaning non-sequential numbering from elements 1-6)
8. Discussion	
9. Multiple Experiments (Optional)	
10. Meta-Analyses (Optional)	
11. References	
12. Footnotes (Optional)	
13. Appendices and Supplemental Materials (Optional)	8. Appendices and Supplemental Materials (Optional)

Please consult the APA resources listed above for questions about the APA Style. For further clarification, questions can be directed to the Academic Success Center Lab at <https://my.kettering.edu/page/writing-support>. Questions concerning Kettering University’s Thesis Manuscript Submission Requirements can be directed to thesis@kettering.edu.

Guide to Writing Elements of the Kettering Written Thesis Manuscript

1. Title Page: Title, Author Name & Author Note (*see Written Thesis Manuscript Modification Example – separate document available in Blackboard Faculty Thesis Advisor Organization) Do according to the example. The intent here is just to standardize the front of these documents so when a researcher in the future is trying to find the one they need, it's easy to scan the relevant information rapidly.

2. Abstract

Your thesis, again, is really a tool to be used by others. Imagine you're looking for information to build something or create a methodology to test some structure. You don't want 15 different papers each with 3 full pages to read to see if those papers can help you. It would be far better to be able to just read a single paragraph that tells you the basic approach, gives you an idea of the method they chose, as well as if their result might be useful to you.

Example: If you need to build a suspended bridge truss, a paper about an underwater application of bridge support materials might not be the most useful to you. But if the person writing thinks only about underwater supports for bridges and fails to mention in the abstract that their work was specific to that application, you could easily get to the method section before realizing you've wasted your time.

3. Table of Contents (*see Written Thesis Manuscript Modification Example – separate document available in Blackboard Faculty Thesis Advisor Organization) This is a word-based map of your paper. The more complex your paper, the closer in you'll likely want to zoom the scope of your Table of Contents.

4. Introduction

If the reader has made it this far they've decided - assuming your abstract was usefully executed - that they want to begin digging into your work, the path you walked. Understanding most things requires understanding the context they exist within. The Introduction is the space to include whatever information is needed by another person to understand the context of your work. Why was it funded? By whom? What were the criteria of a "good" solution? Were you encouraged to explore for the best answer, or directed to find the first acceptable answer? How did you approach thinking about the problem at hand, and what information, context, and definitions does your reader need to follow along with your thought process?

5. Conclusions and Recommendations (*see Written Thesis Manuscript Modification Example – separate document available in Blackboard Faculty Thesis Advisor Organization) What is the meaning of what actually wound up happening? This can be hard to separate in our mind from the later "Results" section. Conclusions are more about understanding what occurred, rather than giving the data of what occurred.

*And then Recommendations: what do you wish you, personally, would have known before you started? What would you have done differently? This section is very important, but it's honestly pretty simple in terms of what its job is: help your reader be more efficient, make better decisions, and get better results, to the best of your ability.

*Recommendations could also be just what the person reading your paper should do as a result of the things you've found. This is a more proper "Recommendation" section for a business report or SWOT analysis type thesis.

6. Method

This section will contain each and every step, machine used, part number of router bits or GitHub locations of utilities or chemical storehouse name where reagents were sourced from. Whatever knowledge a person would need to exactly duplicate your procedure, it should be included here. This is not just a recipe for your project, it's a written copy of every move and piece that came into play in your work.

7. Results

Here is where the data you've created goes. This section is intended to be really poured over, if the person reading your thesis decides they want to fully understand what happened in your project. That said, if you have two hundred pages of tables, only the most relevant, or most useful to understand how to read those tables should appear here. It's a balancing act, when you have tons of information: to include everything needed while not so much as to bury the usefulness of what is actually required. In that same vein, this is also the area where you include everything which came from your work you might need in the following Discussion section.

8. Discussion

The discussion section is where you teach your audience what you, now, are able to. This can be a difficult section to understand its purpose, at first glance. The Discussion section is where you synthesize everything that happened during your project into an explanation of the reasons this research was valuable. If that is brand new results never before seen,

great. If you learned that your chosen approach was just totally wrong for the question you asked, that's useful to know, too. If you realized that you'd been asking the entirely wrong question, that's also an important thing to tell other people who might accidentally try to take the same approach.

9. Multiple Experiments (Optional)

Other, optional, sets of Method, Results, and Discussion.

10. Meta-Analyses (Optional)

A secondary Discussion section where you compare multiple full experiments for what can be learned from comparing them.

11. References

12. Footnotes (Optional)

A place for explanations that aren't critical to grasping your project, but which could help contextualize what happened for a very interested reader.

13. Appendices and Supplemental Materials (Optional)

Every table, figure, line of code, picture of intermediary steps, or other relevant but overwhelmingly large data set. This is also a fine place to include definitions, a glossary of acronyms, initialisms, and jargon that might be confusing, or other such material.

Quick Reference Guide for APA Changes

Transition from Version 6.0 to Version 7.0

Chapter	Changes
2 Paper Elements and Formatting	- No longer write "RUNNING HEAD" verbatim on title page, the descriptive running head should be in all caps, and no longer than 50 characters - Wider range of fonts accepted, including Calibri 11, Arial 11, Lucida Sans Unicode 10, Times New Roman 12, and Georgia 11 - Heading levels formatting changed*
4 Writing Style and Grammar	- Singular "they" not only endorsed but preferred unless gender is essential to include - Avoid anthropomorphizing language*
5 Bias-Free Language Guidelines	- Makes suggestions to reduce bias in language "Person-first" language - Mention only attributes of a person that matter, and then be as specific as possible - Not, "homeless people in Michigan", but rather, "people experiencing homelessness in rural areas of Michigan"
6 Mechanics of Style	- Single space after a period - Quotation marks rather than italics to indicate examples of words - Many other small clarifications, as well*
7 Tables and Figures	- Same rules for both tables and figures, now - They should appear either in line or after the references
8 Works Cited in the Text	- Three or more authors: use the fewest number of names that uniquely identifies which source is being cited, followed by "et al." - New guidelines for citing Oral Traditions and Traditional Knowledge of Indigenous People - New guidelines on formatting quotations from study participants
9 Reference List	- Up to 20 authors listed before an ellipsis is used - DOIs and URLs both presented as hyperlinks - New guidelines on DOI and URL entries - "DOI:" no longer used; "Retrieved from" is only used when a retrieval date is going to be included, for clarity in reading.
Notes and Sources:	* Please see Publication Manual of the APA, 7th Edition for further detail and examples. This is only a partial, quick guide to the changes made by the APA Sources: https://apastyle.apa.org/products/publication-manual-7th-edition-introduction.pdf https://www.scribbr.com/apa-style/apa-seventh-edition-changes/ https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/apa_changes_7th_edition.html